



Ervine, Craig

ZIM

vs right-arm pace

Zimbabwe M · LHB · How to exploit — right-arm pace plan

RUNS

659

25 dismissals · 66 inns

AVERAGE

26.4

3-YR 12.0

STRIKE RATE

69.3

3-YR 59.2

MEDIAN % OF RUNS

8.7%

of team, per innings

3-YR 14.4%

CARRIES THE INNINGS

21%

innings with ≥25% of team

3-YR 18%

SUMMARY

- A solid, steady batter — vulnerable to seam.
- Plan for right-arm pace: bowl **good length pitching on the stumps**.
- They get out most often to balls that are **full and down the leg side** (4.5 dismissals/100).
- Most often out **caught behind** (36% of dismissals); most often to right fast (19).

COMMON THEMES

- left-hand bat, averaging 26.4 at a strike rate of 69.3.
- Carries a big share of the batting — 13.5% of team runs.
- Scores mainly through the V (35%).

STRENGTHS

- Main scoring shot is the drive (38% of runs).
- The **slog** brings them 10% of their runs vs right-arm pace — 1.8× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **pull/hook** vs right-arm pace (6% of runs vs 20% typically).
- Starts securely — their dismissal rate barely drops once set (2.6 early vs 2.7/100); early pressure alone won't buy their wicket. Early runs come mainly off the drive (44%).

WEAKNESSES / HOW TO GET HIM

- Most often out **caught behind** (36% of dismissals); most often to right fast (19).
- Vulnerable to the **good length** (averages 19 there vs 26 overall; 2.9 dismissals/100).
- Most dangerous ball: **full and down the leg side** (4.5 dismissals/100, avg 16).
- His **pull/hook** is high-risk (false shot 32%, 9.8 outs/100).

Start of Innings vs Set

Starts securely — their dismissal rate barely drops once set (2.6 early vs 2.7/100); early pressure alone won't buy their wicket. Early runs come mainly off the drive (44%).

Phase	Average	Strike rate	False-shot %	Dismissals / 100	Boundary %	Balls
First 30 balls	23.5	61	20%	2.60	8%	654
Once set (31+)	32.5	88	13%	2.69	11%	297

v Bangladesh · 1 Test · 100 balls · 60 runs · avg 60.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v Afghanistan · 1 Test · 8 balls · 5 runs · avg 5.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v New Zealand · 2 Tests · 228 balls · 85 runs · avg 21.2
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

Only the balls of each attack's pace plan that differed from what the same bowlers gave that side's other LHB top-order batters. The full dismissal detail sits in the vision playlists.

Our Best Options (simulated matchups)

From the match simulation — a tool that plays each batter-v-bowler pairing out thousands of times from their full Test profiles. Low expected average = the bowler wins the matchup. "Cohort" confidence = they have not faced enough of that type for a personal read.

Bowler	Type	Exp avg	Exp SR	Out in first 30 %	Stock wicket ball	Top dismissal	Confidence
Xavier Bartlett	Right pace	21.2	72.7	57.1	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 26.9%	High
Josh Hazlewood	Right pace	26.6	71.6	49.2	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.6%	Med
Nathan Ellis	Right pace	30.9	80.1	48.1	short, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.8%	High
Adam Zampa	Leg-spin	32.3	91.6	55.8	good length, outside off	LBW 21.5%	Cohort
Mitch Marsh	Right pace	33.9	86.4	48.5	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.1%	Med

Structurally, off-spin turning the ball away from the LHB is the matchup class that persists — favour that angle when the individual reads are thin.

Where They're Vulnerable (right-arm pace)

Per bucket: batting average, strike rate, false-shot %, dismissals per 100 balls, boundary %. Pink row = their lowest-average (softest) bucket in that dimension.

Seam movement

Seam movement	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
no seam	82.0	80	6%	0.98	11%	102
seams away	23.0	50	17%	2.17	7%	46

Length

Length	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Full	46.5	98	16%	2.11	16%	95
Good length	19.0	56	16%	2.92	5%	479
Back of a length	—	135	12%	0.00	22%	51

Speed

Speed	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
<125	—	96	2%	0.00	14%	51
125–133	44.0	77	14%	1.75	11%	57

Swing

Swing	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
no swing	—	82	12%	0.00	13%	68
swings away	31.5	69	9%	2.20	8%	91

Pitching line

Pitching line	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
outside off	32.5	84	9%	2.60	12%	77
on the stumps	22.8	66	20%	2.90	8%	656
down the leg side	46.0	75	16%	1.63	9%	184

Over vs round

Over vs round	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Round the wicket	22.0	68	20%	3.09	8%	194
Over the wicket	27.7	70	17%	2.51	9%	757

DANGER BALL — WHERE THEY'RE MOST LIKELY OUT

Full / down the leg side

4.5 dismissals per 100 · averages 16 here · 44 balls · false shot 22%

How They Score & Get Out

Scores most of their runs through straight down the ground (35%; off 31% · leg 34% · straight 35%).

Shot types (risk) [▶ their pull/hook](#)

Shot	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Pull/Hook	15.5	151	32%	9.76	27%	41
Drive	34.5	99	25%	2.87	15%	209
Cut	49.0	163	13%	3.33	23%	30
Work/Nudge	50.8	72	13%	1.42	5%	281

Scoring mix vs the typical Test batter (vs right-arm pace)

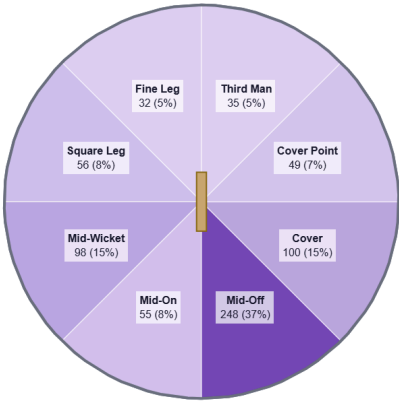
The **slog** brings them 10% of their runs vs right-arm pace — 1.8× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **pull/hook** vs right-arm pace (6% of runs vs 20% typically).

Shot	% of their runs	Typical	Index	Pctl
Drive	40%	33%	1.2×	P86
Work/Nudge	33%	29%	1.2×	P75
Slog	10%	6%	1.8×	P83
Cut	8%	8%	1.1×	P57
Pull/Hook	6%	20%	0.3×	P1
Sweep	2%	0%	5.8×	P78
Ramp/Scoop	0%	1%	0.0×	P40

Share of stroke-coded runs vs right-arm pace; index = their share ÷ cohort median (138 Test batters). Highlight = signature shot; ▼ = scores unusually little there.

Most often out **caught behind** (36% of dismissals); most often to right fast (19). [▶ watch dismissals](#)

Dismissal mode	Count	%
Caught behind	9	36%
Caught in the field	6	24%
Bowled	6	24%
Caught	4	16%



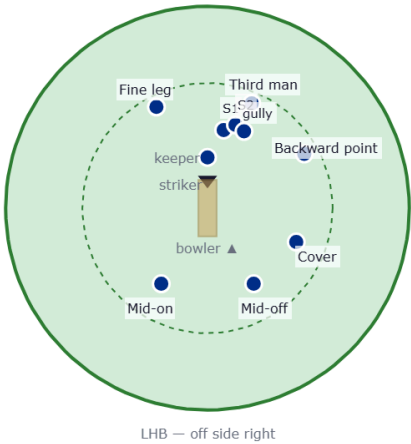
Where they score — runs by area vs right-arm pace (mirrored for a left-hander).

Suggested Fields (the stock field ± their evidenced deviations)

Each field starts from the **stock template** for that bowler type & phase (orthodox because it works), then makes at most **three** changes — each one earned by a trigger in **their** game clearing the cohort P75 bar (do they lap, cut, pull, score square, edge early?). **Change** rows are highlighted with their stat; **Stock** rows carry the orthodox line. The read line backtests the changes against the pure stock field. Early = first 30 balls; Set = once in. Drawn from behind the bowler (bowler bottom, striker top); off side is on the right.

Field vs right-arm pace

Early — first 30 balls · 654 balls

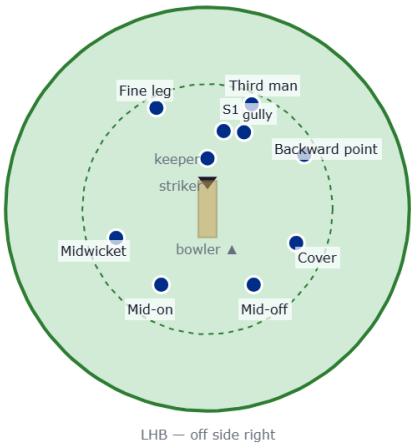


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
2nd slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Gully	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Third man	Stock	Standard stock position.

Pure stock field. Nothing in their game clears the deviation bar (cohort P75) against right-arm pace, so the orthodox field stands — that is the read.

Floating fielder: They score only 3% of their runs where mid-off stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.

Once set · 297 balls

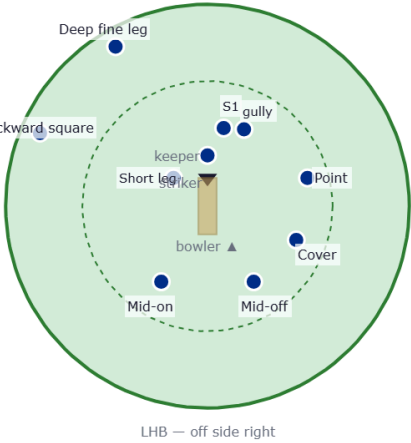


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Gully	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Third man	Stock	Standard stock position.

Pure stock field. Nothing in their game clears the deviation bar (cohort P75) against right-arm pace, so the orthodox field stands — that is the read.

Floating fielder: They score only 2% of their runs where mid-off stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.

Bouncer plan



Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Change	One slip kept for the top / outside edge.
Short leg	Change	Catcher in front of square for the fend or glove off the hip.
Gully	Change	The steer or fend that flies squarer of the wicket.
Point	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Cover	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Mid-off	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Mid-on	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Deep backward square	Change	Deep behind square for the top-edged pull.
Deep fine leg	Change	Deep behind square for the hook.

A standard bumper field — he isn't a heavy puller (P7), so this is a holding / surprise option, not a wicket-taking plan. One slip, a catcher in front of square, and the two legal leg-side riders (deep backward square + deep fine leg).